

## SPECIAL PROGRAM OR ACADEMY PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT AND APPROVAL PROCESS

The approval process for special programs and academies is outlined in this Regulation.

A. Program Proposal. The program proposal must set forth the objectives and an implementation budget for year one and an estimated budget for years two through five. The program proposal must include an evaluation design approved by the Division of Research, Assessment & School Improvement.

B. Special Program or Academy Proposal Development. Prior to the development of a special program or academy proposal, the School Division will approve the initiation of the proposal development. The program proposal shall align to the LCPS Strategic Framework, division goals and core beliefs, and support the LCPS Profile of a Graduate. The program proposal shall set forth goals and objectives and include an annual evaluation to ensure that the goals, objectives, and budgetary considerations are met. All program proposals shall include a timeline for implementation and a sunset provision whereby the School Board must take action to continue the program or academy. The program proposal must incorporate stakeholder feedback and representation from targeted school-based groups including students, teachers, parents/legal guardians, administrators, and community stakeholders. All program proposals must be submitted using the Special Program or Academy Proposal template.

1. A program proposal must include the following components:
  - a. Overview: This section of the program proposal is an overview that should include a narrative that succinctly answers the following questions:
    - (i) What is the special program or academy designed to accomplish? What will students be able to know and do after completing this program? What college or career will this program prepare students for? Will students earn any industry certifications or licenses?
    - (ii) Who will have access to the services of the special program?
    - (iii) What students and how many will this special program or academy accommodate?
    - (iv) Who will deliver the services?

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- (v) How will the services be delivered?
- (vi) Where will the special program or academy be housed?
- b. Rationale: This section of the program proposal should include a narrative justification for the program (special program or academy) that answers the following questions:
  - (i) Why is the program or academy needed?
  - (ii) What data supports the need for the program?
  - (iii) Has the program been tried elsewhere? If so, what were the results?
  - (iv) Is the proposed program identified in professional literature as a best practice or promising trend?
  - (v) How does the program support the LCPS Strategic Framework, Division Goals and Core Beliefs, and Profile of a Graduate?
  - (vi) Does the program require a waiver of any of the Standards of Accreditation?
  - (vii) Does the program require a waiver of any School Board policy and regulation(s)?
  - (viii) What program, if any, will this new program replace or is this in addition to an existing program?
- c. Goals and Objectives: This section of the program proposal should include a general statement of the goals of the program or academy followed by a list of specific objectives. Objectives should be:
  - (i) Clearly stated
  - (ii) Observable
  - (iii) Measurable

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- (iv) Backed by research or demonstrated need
  - (v) Related to the program goals
  - (vi) Annual Evaluation plan is included and aligned to the program or academy goals for student outcomes.
- d. Operations and Calendar: This section of the program proposal describes how the program will be operationalized within the School Division and a timeline (calendar) for the implementation process. This section should answer the following questions:
- (i) What school-based level(s) (ES/MS/HS) would this apply to?
  - (ii) What content area(s)?
  - (iii) How would this impact scheduling? Include a sample Master Schedule.
  - (iv) Are there any prerequisites to the program? If so, what are they and why are they necessary for participation?
  - (v) What is the number of students this program can accommodate?
  - (vi) What specialized courses will be included in this program (include grade, course description, course code)? Will the academy or special program theme be embedded in core content and required courses? Include a sample student schedule if applicable.
  - (vii) Include any VDOE teacher licensure endorsements required to support the program.
  - (viii) Create a timeline of major milestones and events. Include a 1-year and a 4-year timeline of implementation.
  - (ix) How will you incorporate deeper learning and culturally responsive instruction?

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- (x) What space will be needed (retrofit, existing, or new)? What specialized equipment is needed?
  - (xi) Who will be the administrator supervising the program? Is additional administrative support needed? Provide contact information.
  - (xii) Are there any existing special courses or programs at your school?
  - (xiii) Are there community or business partners that will assist with work-based learning, and community connections?
  - (xiv) What additional stakeholders were involved in the development of this proposal (students, families, teachers, administrators, community members)?
  - (xv) What impact will this have on students at the host school not participating in the special program?
- e. Staffing: This section Program Proposal should contain the following information:
- (i) What staff is required to implement the program?
  - (ii) Are there additional positions or supports that are not met through the staffing standards (i.e. administrative support, digital experience specialist, school counselors)?
  - (iii) What additional division level supports (curriculum development, etc.) may be required?
  - (iv) What specialized qualifications (licensure) will the staff be required to possess?
  - (v) How will the staff be trained? What professional learning will need to be developed, and who will be responsible for that? How will the training be evaluated?
- f. Budget: This section of the program proposal describes the costs of the program. All projected costs including salaries, training, supplies, materials, equipment, technology, space renovations, textbooks, and transportation must be included. The budget should identify both start-up costs (year one) and annual recurring costs.

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In order to provide accurate cost estimates, writers must consult with Division Offices (HRTD, DOI, DDI, Budget and Finance).

- g. Evaluation: This section of the program proposal outlines the plan for annual evaluation design and should be collaboratively developed by the program originators and a representative from Research, Assessment & School Improvement. The evaluation design should answer the following questions:
- (i) What research questions will be used to evaluate the effectiveness of the program?
  - (ii) What data will be collected for each research question?
  - (iii) When will the data be collected?
  - (iv) How will the data be collected?
  - (v) How will the data be analyzed?
  - (vi) What indicators will be used to measure program implementation and effectiveness?
  - (vii) How does the annual evaluation plan adequately address the student outcome goals?

C. Special Program or Academy Review and Approval Process. The Special Program or Academy Proposal Review and Approval Process defines the process flow from initiation through School Board approval. The Program Review Committee is responsible for validation of the assumptions in the proposal with respect to student interest, viability, and sustainability, and is fiscally responsible. The review committee is made up of representatives from the following departments:

1. Business & Finance
2. Instruction
3. Digital Innovation
4. Human Resources & Talent Development
5. Support Services

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6. Student Services

Upon approval by the Program Review Committee, the Program Proposal will be submitted to the Deputy Superintendent and Cabinet for review and approval. Upon the Superintendent's approval, the program proposal will be forwarded to the School Board for review and approval. If School Board approval and authorization are granted, and funding is allocated, a project would be initiated to develop the program and the initial implementation plan.

D. Process for Special Program or Academy Implementation, Evaluation, and Continuation, Expansion or Phase Out

1. Implementation. The special program or academy project implementation will be initiated after the School Board's formal approval of the Program Proposal.

- a. Evaluation and Reauthorization. No later than May 30 each year, the special program or academy will submit a report of progress to the School Board. Each special program or academy will be evaluated for reauthorization by the School Board; this date will be subject to School Board approval and shall be no more than 5 years after the program's implementation date. Each program will be reauthorized every 10 years after the initial reauthorization.

- (i) Continuation, Expansion or Termination of an Existing Special Program or Academy

- (a) Continuation

- The continuation of an existing special program or academy beyond the time period identified in the Program Proposal is at the discretion of the School Board. This decision will be based on the availability of funds, enrollment, and the recommendations from evaluations.

- Based on recommendations during the evaluation process, special programs or academies may be modified to improve delivery of instructional services. At the end of full implementation of a special program, the School Board will receive the evaluation with a recommendation regarding the status to continue, expand, or phase out the special program.

- (b) Expansion

- The expansion of an existing special program or

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academy beyond the scope of the Program Proposal is within the sole discretion of the School Board. Based on recommendations during the evaluation process, effective programs or academies may be recommended for expansion to other schools within the School Division.

(c) Termination

An existing special program or academy may be terminated upon the recommendation of the Superintendent in the event that the Superintendent determines that there is a lack of interest or change in circumstance. Low enrollment, insufficient staffing, or issues with the quality of implementation may be factors. If a special program is terminated before the proposed end date, all students who are currently enrolled in the special program shall have the opportunity to complete their course of studies wherever feasible. The division shall make all reasonable efforts to continue the program or academy course for students currently enrolled. However, the financial impacts, student interest, staffing considerations, and Superintendent discretion will inform the decision.